UNIT 35.3 · LEVEL B2

Questions – past for politeness

50 questions · 6 parts

Date: _____ Score: _____ / 50

When you finish, check the Answer Key at the end of this unit.

Part A · Multiple Choice (questions 1–10)

Circle the letter of the correct answer.

1 I _____ if you could help me with this.

a) wonder **b)** am wonder **c)** was wondering **d)** wondering

2 Excuse me, _____ you looking for something?

a) were **b)** did **c)** have **d)** had

3 I _____ to ask if you had a spare ticket.

a) wanting **b)** had want **c)** was want **d)** wanted

4 Which is the most polite?

a) Give me a pen.
b) Could you possibly lend me a pen?
c) Do you have a pen?
d) Lend me a pen, please.

5 I was hoping you _____ lend me your car.

a) can **b)** could **c)** may **d)** will

6 _____ you want to pay by card, sir?

a) Are **b)** Were **c)** Have **d)** Did

7 Which sentence is the most tentative?

a) I was wondering if you could help me.
b) I wonder if you can help me.
c) I'm wondering if you can help me.
d) I wonder if you could to help me.

8 I _____ thinking of asking you a favour.

a) am **b)** were **c)** was **d)** had

9 We _____ wondering whether you'd like to join us.

a) did **b)** had **c)** been **d)** were

10 Which is correct?

a) I was wondering if you could help.
b) I was wondered if you could help.
c) I was wondering if could you help.
d) I wondering if you could help.

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Part B · Fill in the Gaps (questions 11–20)

Write the missing word in each blank.

11 I _____ (wonder) if you could give me some advice.

12 I _____ (hope) you could lend me some money.

13 _____ you want to see the manager, sir?

14 I _____ (want) to ask you something.

15 _____ you looking for anything in particular?

16 I was wondering if you _____ (can) open the window.

17 I _____ (think) you might like some help.

18 I was wondering _____ you could send me the report.

19 Excuse me, I _____ (wonder) whether you had a free table.

20 I _____ (hope) we could meet next week.

Part C · Unscramble the Words (questions 21–28)

Put the words in the correct order to make a sentence. Write it on the line. Remember the capital letter and the full stop.

21 **I / was / wondering / if / you / could / help / me**

_____

22 **I / was / hoping / you / could / lend / me / a / pen**

_____

23 **did / you / want / to / see / the / manager**

_____

24 **I / wanted / to / ask / you / a / favour**

_____

25 **were / you / looking / for / something / in / particular**

_____

26 **I / was / wondering / whether / you / had / a / free / table**

_____

27 **we / were / wondering / if / you'd / like / to / join / us**

_____

28 **could / you / possibly / lend / me / a / pen**

_____

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Part D · Choose and Complete (questions 29–35)

Choose the correct option and write it in the blank.

29 *Choose the polite form.*
I _____ if you could help me.
Options: **was wondering** / **wonder** / **am wondering**

30 *Choose the polite form.*
_____ you want to pay by card?
Options: **Did** / **Do** / **Have**

31 *Choose the correct form.*
I was hoping you _____ lend me some money.
Options: **could** / **can** / **will**

32 *Choose the polite form.*
Excuse me, _____ you looking for something?
Options: **were** / **did** / **have**

33 *Choose the polite form.*
I _____ to ask if you had a pen.
Options: **wanted** / **want** / **wanting**

34 *Choose the polite form.*
We _____ wondering if you'd like some tea.
Options: **were** / **did** / **been**

35 *Choose the missing word.*
Could you _____ lend me a pen?
Options: **possibly** / **probably** / **lately**

Part E · Matching (questions 36–40)

Match the items. Write the correct letter next to each number.

36 Match each direct question to a more polite version.

1. Can you help me? _____
2. Do you want a table? _____
3. Give me a pen. _____
4. Are you looking for something? _____

A. Did you want a table?
B. Were you looking for something?
C. I was wondering if you could help me.
D. Could you possibly lend me a pen?

37 Match each situation to a polite phrase.

1. asking for help _____
2. offering a table _____
3. borrowing a pen _____
4. checking what someone needs _____

A. Were you looking for something?
B. I was wondering if you could help me.
C. Did you want a table for two?
D. I was hoping you could lend me a pen.

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38 Match each incorrect phrase to the correct one.

1. I am wondering if _____
2. Did you wanted _____
3. we was wondering _____
4. if could you _____

A. if you could
B. we were wondering
C. Did you want
D. I was wondering if

39 Match each phrase to its tone.

1. Give me a pen. _____
2. Can you lend me a pen? _____
3. Could you lend me a pen? _____
4. I was wondering if you could lend me a pen. _____

A. neutral
B. polite
C. very polite
D. too direct

40 Match each sentence start to the best ending.

1. I was wondering _____
2. I was hoping _____
3. Did you want _____
4. We were wondering _____

A. to see the manager?
B. if you could help me.
C. whether you'd like to join us.
D. you could lend me a pen.

Part F · Find the Error (questions 41–50)

Each sentence has one mistake. Underline it and write the correct word.

41 I am wondering if you could help me. Correct word: _____

42 I hoped you can lend me a pen. Correct word: _____

43 I was wonder if you could help. Correct word: _____

44 Did you wanting a table for two? Correct word: _____

45 I was wondering if could you help me. Correct word: _____

46 I was hoping you will help me. Correct word: _____

47 We was wondering if you'd like to join us.
Correct word: _____

48 I was hoping that you can lend me a hand.
Correct word: _____

49 I wondered if you could to help me. Correct word: _____

50 Did you wanted to see the manager? Correct word: _____

Your score

Count one point for each correct answer. Below 70%? Review the topic and try the unit again in a few days.

A	B	C	D	E	F	Total
____ / 10	____ / 10	____ / 8	____ / 7	____ / 5	____ / 10	____ **/ 50**

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Answer Key

Questions – past for politeness

Part A · Multiple Choice

1	**c)** was wondering	Past continuous makes a request more polite.
2	**a)** were	Past forms sound more tentative and polite.
3	**d)** wanted	Past simple is more polite.
4	**b)** Could you possibly lend me a pen?	Could + possibly is the most polite.
5	**b)** could	Past forms go with could.
6	**d)** Did	Did you want is a polite past form.
7	**a)** I was wondering if you could help me.	Past continuous + could is the most tentative.
8	**c)** was	Past continuous is more polite.
9	**d)** were	Past continuous is more polite.
10	**a)** I was wondering if you could help.	Use statement order after if.

Part B · Fill in the Gaps

11	**was wondering**	Past continuous makes a request polite.
12	**was hoping**	Past continuous makes a request polite.
13	**Did**	Did you want is a polite past form.
14	**wanted**	Past simple is more polite.
15	**Were**	Were you looking is polite.
16	**could**	Past forms go with could.
17	**was thinking**	Past continuous is polite.
18	**if** (or: whether)	If or whether after wondering.
19	**was wondering**	Past continuous makes it polite.
20	**was hoping**	Past continuous makes it polite.

Part C · Unscramble the Words

21	**I was wondering if you could help me.**	Was wondering + if + could.
22	**I was hoping you could lend me a pen.**	Was hoping + could.
23	**Did you want to see the manager?**	Did you want is polite.
24	**I wanted to ask you a favour.**	Wanted is more polite.
25	**Were you looking for something in particular?**	Were you looking is polite.

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26	**I was wondering whether you had a free table.**	Whether + statement order.
27	**We were wondering if you'd like to join us.**	Were wondering is polite.
28	**Could you possibly lend me a pen?**	Could you possibly is very polite.

Part D · Choose and Complete

29	**was wondering**	Past continuous is polite.
30	**Did**	Did you want is polite.
31	**could**	Past forms go with could.
32	**were**	Were you looking is polite.
33	**wanted**	Past simple is polite.
34	**were**	Were wondering is polite.
35	**possibly**	Could you possibly is very polite.

Part E · Matching

36	**1-C 2-A 3-D 4-B**	Can you help me? – I was wondering if you could help me.; Do you want a table? – Did you want a table?; Give me a pen. – Could you possibly lend me a pen?; Are you looking for something? – Were you looking for something? Past forms are more polite.
37	**1-B 2-C 3-D 4-A**	asking for help – I was wondering if you could help me.; offering a table – Did you want a table for two?; borrowing a pen – I was hoping you could lend me a pen.; checking what someone needs – Were you looking for something? Choose the polite phrase.
38	**1-D 2-C 3-B 4-A**	I am wondering if – I was wondering if; Did you wanted – Did you want; we was wondering – we were wondering; if could you – if you could Fix the common errors.
39	**1-D 2-A 3-B 4-C**	Give me a pen. – too direct; Can you lend me a pen? – neutral; Could you lend me a pen? – polite; I was wondering if you could lend me a pen. – very polite Compare levels of politeness.
40	**1-B 2-D 3-A 4-C**	I was wondering – if you could help me.; I was hoping – you could lend me a pen.; Did you want – to see the manager?; We were wondering – whether you'd like to join us. Choose the logical ending.

Part F · Find the Error

41	**was**	Use the past for politeness.
42	**could**	Past forms go with could.
43	**wondering**	Past continuous: was + -ing.
44	**want**	After did use the base form.
45	**you could**	Statement order after if.
46	**would** (or: could)	Past forms go together.
47	**were**	We takes were.
48	**could**	Past forms go together.
49	**help**	After could use the base form.

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50	**want**	After did use the base form.

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